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Chapter 3

Explorer Designer



What Is Designer?



Warning: *Designer is intended for the System Administrator only.*



Note: You can access Designer only if the Designer field, in the Preferences Window, has been checked. If the Designer field in the Preferences Window is disabled then contact your System Administrator who may want to reset permissions for you.



Note: Designer will not work if you have more than one session active.



Note: Only non Visual Component windows can be reformatted in Explorer.

Designer enables the System Administrator to tailor the System 21 window display for the Explorer user.

You can access Designer by using the Designer button on the toolbar. However this button may not always be available to you. When you start an activity the Designer button is displayed on the toolbar provided that:

- The window is not a Visual Component.
- The Designer field, in the Preferences Window, has been checked.
- There is only one active session. If you start a second session the Designer button becomes automatically disabled.
- The host screen contains a magic number.

Designer Menu Bar

The Designer Menu Bar has three drop-down menu options:

- Project Menu
- Options Menu
- Help Menu.

Project Menu

Menu options:

Restore

You can choose to restore the window you are reformatting to the last one you saved or to the original one which existed when you started to run Explorer.

Save

Save the changes to the window you are reformatting.

Exit

Close Designer without saving the changes to the window you are reformatting.

Options Menu

Menu options:

Hidden Fields

This option displays a list of all your Hidden Fields. Click on any of these to display them again.

Help Menu

Menu options:

Designer Help

Displays the online help to assist you in working with Designer for System 21 Explorer.

About

Displays System 21 version information.

Designer Pop Up Menus

Just as for standard Windows 95 or Windows NT applications, Designer supplies you with useful context sensitive pop up menus. These menus offer you most of the features that you see on the Designer Field Window and the Designer Panel Window. You can choose whether to work with the Designer windows or the pop up menus or a combination of both.

You display the Designer pop up menus when you click with the right mouse button on different parts of the System 21 application window.

There are three types of pop up menus:

- When you click with the right mouse button on an input field the Input Field Pop Up Menu is displayed.
- When you click with the right mouse button on an output field the Output Field Pop Up Menu is displayed.
- When you click with the right mouse button on a space on the application window the Panel Pop Up Menu is displayed.

Input Field Pop Up Menu



To display this Designer menu you click with the right mouse button on an input field on the application window.

Menu Options:

Change Text

Displays the Text Override Window for you to change the text which you can see displayed in a field.

Field Mask

This enables you to change the way in which data is displayed in a field.

When you select this option, from the pop up menu, you display the Text Override Window as a drop down list box. Click on the down arrow and select a display option from the list. The data in the field is immediately reformatted. For example, you could change 733.00 to 733 using the Remove Decimal option or you could change 733 to 733.00 using the Zero Pad option.

Add Prompt



Note: The attributes are enabled only for input fields.

This makes a prompt button available to the application user alongside the current field and displays the Prompt Details Window. To remove the Prompt later you can click on the Prompt symbol and take the Details option.

Details

This option is available when you click on an existing prompt. It displays the Prompt Details Window for you to amend details or remove the Prompt.

Sticky Field

Displays the Field Variables Window.

Document Link

Displays the Document Link Window.

Hide

Check this to hide the field.



Tip: You can redisplay the field by selecting Hidden Fields on the Panel Pop Up Menu and selecting the field name from the pop up list.

Read Only

Click this to make the selected input field read only.

Border

Change the border of the field to:

2 Deep - Border recessed by 2 pixels

3 Deep - Border recessed by 3 pixels

None - 1 pixel single line border.

The borders/objects rules are:

- Input fields can be recessed by 2 or 3 pixels or have a 1 pixel plain border.
- Output field descriptions can have no border or a bevelled border.

Output Field Pop Up Menu



To display this Designer menu you click with the right mouse button on an output field on the application window.

Menu Options:

Change Text

Displays the Text Override Window for you to change the text which you can see displayed in a field.

Field Mask

Displays the Text Override Window. Click on the down arrow and select a display option from the list. The data in the field is immediately reformatted.

Sticky Field

Displays the Field Variables Window.

Document Link

Displays the Document Link Window.

Hide

Check this to hide the field.



Tip: You can redisplay the field by selecting Hidden Fields on the Panel Pop Up Menu and selecting the field name from the pop up list.

Attributes



Note: The attributes are enabled only for output fields.



Tip: You can change the attributes of several fields at once by putting a rectangular dotted line around the fields. You do this by clicking with the left mouse button and dragging and dropping the rectangle.

Change the attributes to:

Reverse - Reverse the image.

Bold - Bold the text.

Underscore - Underline the text.

Blink - Colour the text.

Column Separators - Colour the text. If more than one field highlighted this only colours the text of one of the columns highlighted.

Border

Change the border of the field to:

2 Deep - Border recessed by 2 pixels.

3 Deep - Border recessed by 3 pixels.

None - 1 pixel single line border.

The borders/objects rules are:

- Input fields can be recessed by 2 or 3 pixels or have a 1 pixel plain border.
- Output field descriptions can have no border or a bevelled border.

Panel Pop Up Menu



To display this Designer menu you click with the right mouse button on a space on the application window.

Menu Options:

Group Box Mode

Use this option to group common fields on a display. This is what you do:

Select the Group Box Mode option: a tick alongside the option will show that it is enabled and the cursor changes to a cross with a small grey rectangle.

Hold the left mouse button down and drag the cursor over the window, drop it and draw a box around the fields which you want to group. An outline of the group box is displayed for you.



You can move this group box around the screen to reposition and resize it. To do this you position the cursor anywhere inside the group box and hold down the left mouse button. The cursor changes to a cross with four arrowheads. Continue to hold the mouse button and drag the box to a new position.

Click with the right mouse button on the group box to display two options:

- Remove Group Box. Select this to remove the box outline from the window.
- Change Text. Select this to highlight the name of the box and change it.

Click on the right mouse button to display the pop up menu again and select the Group Box Mode option to disable it.

Add Button

Displays the Custom Button Details Window.

Details

Displays the Panel Details Window.

Add Help

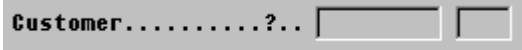
Displays the Help Details Window.

Remove Stops

Checked (Default) - This takes out the row of dots that is included by default in field descriptions. This is what you get:



Unchecked - This leaves in the row of dots that is included by default in field descriptions. This is what you get:



Hide Panel

Check this box to hide the window which you are currently reformatting with Designer.

Typical Usage:

- You could replace the functionality of the window with your own VB application.
- You could set the text in the input fields and set a Function Key to be pressed automatically and hide the panel. This would automatically imitate the way the user might use the window but in practice the user would not see the window at all. Please refer to Change Text on the Designer Field Window and Select A Key To Press on the Designer Panel window.

Remove Group Box



Note: This option is enabled only when Group Box Mode is enabled.

This displays a drop down list of all the group boxes created using the Group Box Mode. Select the Group Box you wish to delete. There is also an option to remove all the group boxes.

Hidden Fields



Note: This option is enabled only when Group Box Mode is disabled.

This option displays a list of all your Hidden Fields. Click on any of these to display them again.

Designer Windows

The following sections give you detailed information, about using Explorer Designer, for each window.

Custom Button Details Window



To display this window click either the Add Button button from the Designer Panel Window or the Add Button option on the Panel Pop Up Menu.

You can add a button to the window you are reformatting within Designer and attach it to some programming function.

Fields:

Row

Enter the number of rows from the top of the window for the position of the new button.

Column

Enter the number of columns from the left of the window for the position of the new button.

Button Text

Enter the text which you want to display alongside the new button.

Action

Use this group box to identify the function to be called when your new button is pressed. Enter the Server and Class to identify the function. It has to be an ActiveX project: you cannot attach it to any .EXE programming function. Please refer to System 21 Technical Information for interface details.

Buttons:

OK

Save the changes and close the window.

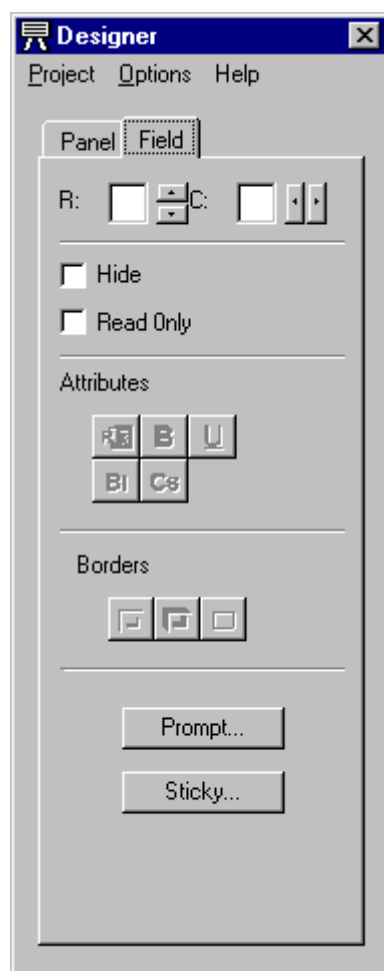
Cancel

Close the window without saving the changes.

Designer Field Window



To display this window click the Designer button from the Main Menu Bar and select the Field tab.



Note: You can also use these features from the pop up menus. Click with the right mouse button on the application window.

You can reformat elements of individual fields. You can move fields around the window and change their appearance.



Tip: First select the fields you want to reformat and then apply the characteristics on the Field panel.



Note: Not all options on the Designer Field Window are available for all fields. It depends on whether the field is an input field or an output field.

Fields:

R (Row)

Enter the number of rows from the top of the screen for the position of the field.

C (Column)

Enter the number of columns from the left of the screen for the position of the field.

Hide

Check this to hide the field.



Tip: You can redisplay the field by selecting Hidden Fields from the Options Menu and selecting the field name from the pop up list.

Read Only

Check this to make the selected input field read only.

Attributes



Note: The attributes are enabled only for output fields.



Tip: You can change the attributes of several fields at once by putting a rectangular dotted line around the fields. You do this by clicking with the left mouse button and dragging and dropping the rectangle.



Reverse the image.



Bold the text.



Underline the text.



Reserved for future use.



Reserved for future use.

Borders

Change the border of the field to:



- Border recessed by 2 pixels.



- Border recessed by 3 pixels.



- 1 pixel single line border.

The borders/objects rules are:

Input fields can be recessed by 2 or 3 pixels or have a 1 pixel plain border.

Output field descriptions can have no border or a bevelled border.

Buttons:

Prompt



Note: The attributes are enabled only for input fields.

This button makes a prompt button available to the application user alongside the current field. The Prompt Details Window is displayed.

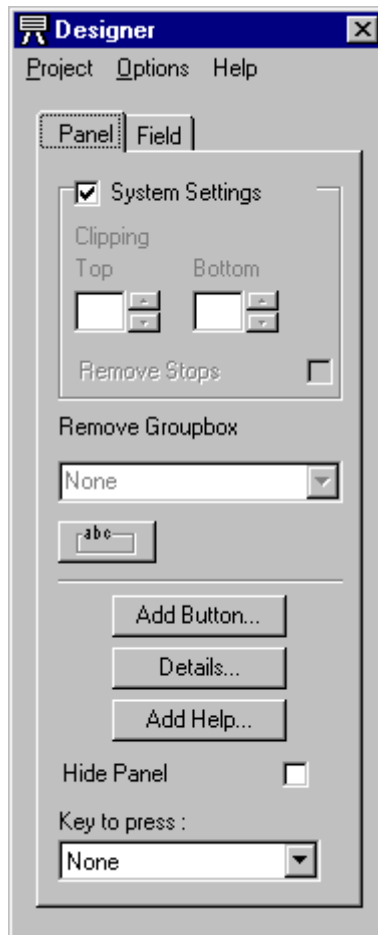
Sticky Field

Displays the Field Variables Window.

Designer Panel Window



To display this window click the Designer button from the Main Menu Bar and select the Panel tab.



Note: You can also use these features from the pop up menus. Click with the right mouse button on the application window.

You can reformat elements of the entire window.

Fields and Buttons:



Warning: The fields called *Top*, *Bottom* and *Remove Stops* are displayed both in this *Designer Panel Window* and the *Preferences Window* within a group box called *System Wide Settings*. The difference is that you use the *Preferences Window* to set options for the whole system but you use the *Designer Panel Window* to set options only for the active window.

System Settings

This is a check box that controls the availability of all these fields: Top, Bottom and Remove Stops. You can only use these fields if the check box is unchecked.

Check the box to take the clipping settings, for the window you are reformatting, from the System Wide Settings on the Preferences Screen Window.

Leave the box unchecked if you prefer to enter your own settings in the Top and Bottom fields directly below.

Top

This spin button group box is used to specify how many lines are to be removed from the top of the screens when they are displayed.

The top two lines of a System 21 default window usually show the program name, company and user, date and time. The appearance can be improved by removing these lines and the freeing up of the pixels improves the resolution of the screen.

If the Company Name is clipped from the window you can easily check on this in Explorer Activity Manager.

The default for the clipping at the top is two lines.

Bottom

This spin button group box is used to specify how many lines are to be removed from the bottom of the windows when they are displayed.

The bottom two lines of a System 21 default window usually show status information.

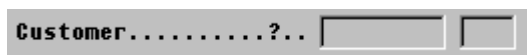
The default for the clipping at the top is two lines.

Remove Stops

Checked (Default) - This takes out the row of dots that is included by default in field descriptions. This is what you get:



Unchecked - This leaves in the row of dots that is included by default in field descriptions. This is what you get:



Remove Group Box

A drop down list of all the group boxes created using the Group Box Mode button. Select the Group Box you wish to delete from the list.

Group Box Mode



Use this button to group common fields on a display. This is what you do:

Click the button once with the left mouse button. The button changes to Group Box Mode and the cursor changes to a cross with a small grey rectangle.

Hold the left mouse button down and drag the cursor over the window, drop it and draw a box around the fields which you want to group. An outline of the group box is displayed for you.



You can move this group box around the screen to reposition and resize it. To do this you position the cursor anywhere inside the group box and hold down the left mouse button. The cursor changes to a cross with four arrowheads. Continue to hold the mouse button and drag the box to a new position.

Click with the right mouse button on the group box to display two options:

- Remove Group Box. Select this to remove the box outline from the window.
- Change Text. Select this to highlight the name of the box and change it.

Click the Group Box Mode button to return to normal mode.

Add Button

Displays the Custom Button Details Window.

Details

Displays the Panel Details Window.

Add Help

Displays the Help Details Window.

Hide Panel

Check this box to hide the window which you are currently reformatting with Designer.

Typical Usage:

- You could replace the functionality of the window with your own VB application.
- You could set the text in the input fields and set a Function Key to be pressed automatically and hide the window. This would automatically imitate the way the user might use the window but in practice the user would not see the window at all. Please refer to Change Text on the Designer Field Window and Select A Key To Press on the Designer Panel window.

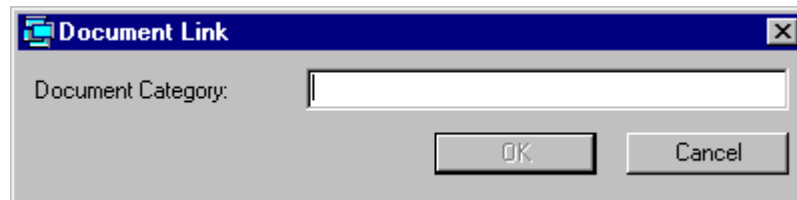
Key To Press

You can set a Function Key to be pressed automatically when the window displays for the user. This means that the user would not touch a Function Key at all. You would probably use this in conjunction with the Hide Panel field also on the Designer Panel window.

Document Link Window



To display this window you must be using Designer to reformat a window. You select a field (input or output) and then click with the right mouse button and select the Document Link option from the pop up menu.



You can set up a link from a field to the Document Viewer so that when the user displays this window the Document Viewer is invoked. The document could be, for example: a letter, an invoice, a diagram of a component.

Please refer to the Preferences Document Viewer Window to determine the way in which the document is displayed. If this window is disabled then please refer to your System Administrator who may want to reset the configuration for you.



Warning: *You can presently set up only one link per window. If you set up more than one link, even using different fields, Designer recognises only the latest one.*

Fields:

Document Category

This is the name of the link with the Document Viewer database. You must make sure that the name here matches that used to register the document in the Document Viewer database. Please refer to the Register A Document Window.



Note: *The Document Viewer database is a list of references to documents and does not hold the documents themselves. The actual documents may be held anywhere on your system. You have to register each document to the database using a two level index: 1st Level - Document Category; 2nd level - Document Key.*



Tip: See your System Administrator for available categories which have already been set up on the Document Viewer database. For example, you may want to link the viewer to an invoice bitmap, and you may have a category on your database called Invoices, which contains all the bitmaps of invoices. So in this instance you might enter Invoices as your Document Category.

Buttons:

OK

Save the changes and close the window.

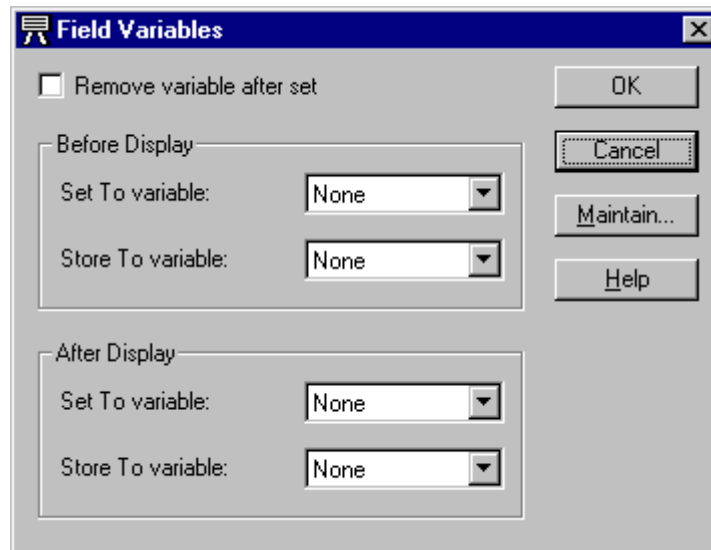
Cancel

Close the window without saving the changes.

Field Variables Window



To display this window you must be using Designer to reformat a window. You select a field (input or output) and then click with the right mouse button and select the Sticky Field option from the pop up menu.



You can do these things:

- Before you display the window at runtime, set the value of an input field to the value held in a sticky field, so the sticky field value is the one displayed.
- Before you display the window at runtime, store the value of an input field to a sticky field, so that it can be retrieved for the next display.
- After you display the window at runtime, set the value of an input field to the value held in a sticky field, so that this value is the one sent to the server.
- After you display the window at runtime, store the value of an input field to a sticky field, so that it can be retrieved for the next display.

Select from the drop down lists the sticky field variables you want to use.

Remove Variable After Set

Applies to the Set options. Delete the set variable after it has been used.

Buttons:

OK

Save the changes and close the window.

Cancel

Close the window without saving the changes.

Maintain

Display the Variable Definition Window.

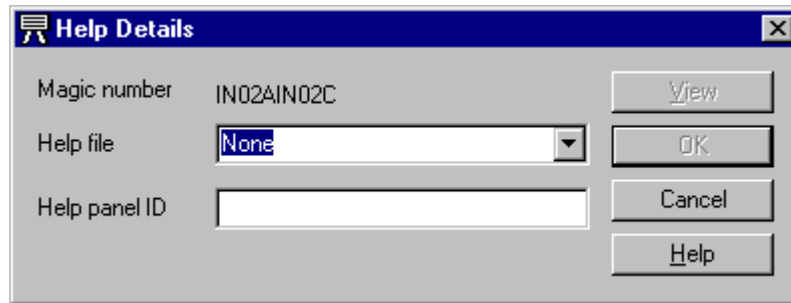
Help

Display help for this window.

Help Details Window



To display this window you must be using Designer to reformat a window. You can either click with the right mouse button on a space on the application window and select the Add Help option from the pop up menu, or you can click the Add Button on the Designer Panel Window.



You can set up a link to a help file. You might want to do this if you have designed your own screens and want to link to your own help file.



*Note: You must put your own help file into
C:\Program Files\JBASys21\Help*

Fields:

Magic Number

Displayed for you.

Help File

Select the name of the help file from the drop down list. For example if you have a help file: C:\Program Files\JBASys21\Help\A1.hlp then you select A1 from the list.

Help Panel ID

The number of the link to the page of the help file. This must be numeric.

Buttons:

View

View the help file. This is only enabled when all the fields are completed.

OK

Save the changes and close the window.

Cancel

Close the window without saving the changes.

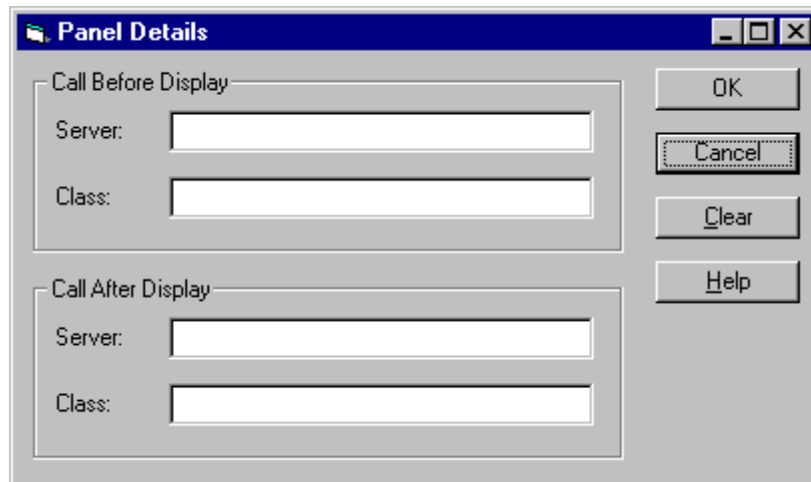
Help

Display help for this window.

Panel Details Window



To display this window either click the Details button from the Designer Panel Window or take the Details option from the Panel Pop Up Menu.



You can call some programming functions before, or after, or both before and after you display the window. You enter a Server and Class to call the function. It has to be an ActiveX project: you cannot call any .Exe programming function.



Note: Please refer to System 21 Technical Information for interface details.



Tip: You might want to do this to insert your own program or screen design.

Buttons:

OK

Save the changes and close the window.

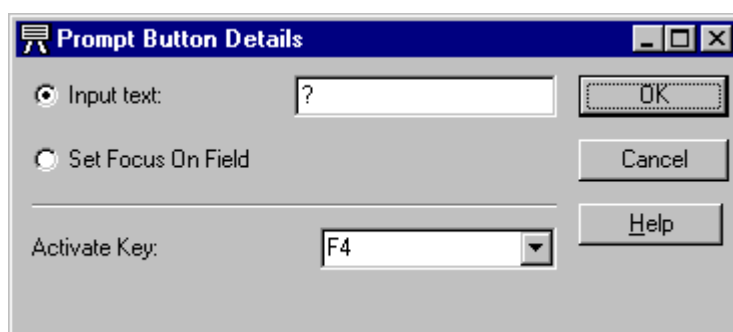
Cancel

Close the window without saving the changes.

Prompt Button Details Window



To display this window you must be using Designer to reformat a window. You select a field and then click the Add Prompt button from the Input Field Pop Up Menu.



You can place a prompt alongside a field.

For example on this window you might enter a question mark as the text and select F4 for the function key. When the System 21 application user selects the prompt (?) alongside the field it has the same effect as if the user had entered ? in the field and then pressed F4.

Fields:

Input Text

Select this to specify the text to be put into the edit field before the user presses the specified key. It is most likely that this will be a question mark. This does not affect what appears on the button alongside the field as this will always be a question mark.

Set Focus On Field

Select this to set the focus to the selected field. This will have the same effect for the user as having pressed the tab keys until the field is selected by the cursor.

Activate Key

Select from a list of facilities for you to include in the prompt activity. For example F4.

Buttons

OK

Save the changes and close the window.

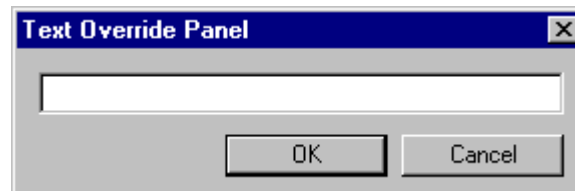
Cancel

Close the window without saving the changes.

Text Override Window



To display this window you must be using Designer to reformat a window. You select a field (input or output) and then click with the right mouse button and select the Change Text option from the pop up menu.



You enter new text here and then when you press OK this new text replaces the original text. When the text is replaced it is automatically displayed in upper case even if you typed it in lower case.

Buttons

OK

Save the changes and close the window.

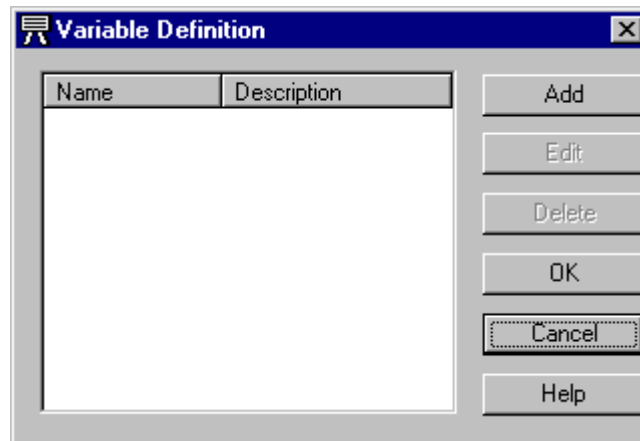
Cancel

Close the window without saving the changes.

Variable Definition Window



To display this window you must be using Designer to reformat a window. You click the Maintain button on the Field Variables Window.



You can maintain a list of variables (sticky fields) from which you can select in order to complete the Field Variables Window.

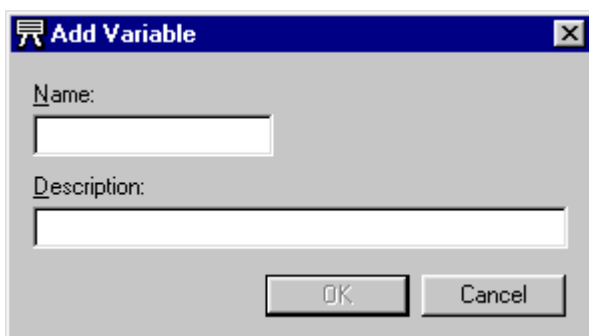


Tip: When you first see the window only one half of it is displayed. If you want to add a variable you will need the remainder. When you click the Add button the window expands to its full width.

There is a list view displaying Name and Description for each listed variable and on the expanded part of the window there are two separate fields also called Name and Description. The buttons are listed down the centre of the window. The list view, the buttons and the two fields work in conjunction with each other. This is what you can do:

Add to the list

Click the Add button and enter a Name and Description in the Add Variable window, then click on the OK button. The new details are added to the list.



Delete from the list

Select an item in the list view and then click the Delete button.

Edit an item in the list

Select an item from the list view, click the Edit button and note that the details are displayed in the Name and Description fields. Make any changes to these fields and the list details change.

Buttons:

Add

Displays the Add Variable Window so you can add an item to the list.

Edit

Edit an item in the list.

Delete

Delete an item from the list.

OK

Save the changes and close the window.

Cancel

Close the window without saving the changes.

Help

Display help for this window.